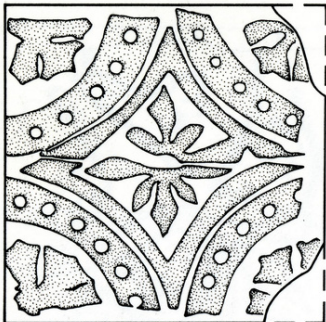
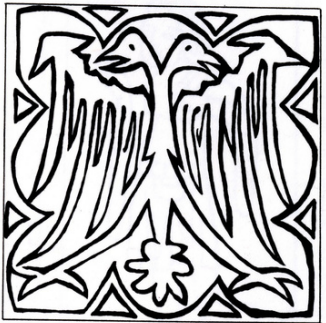
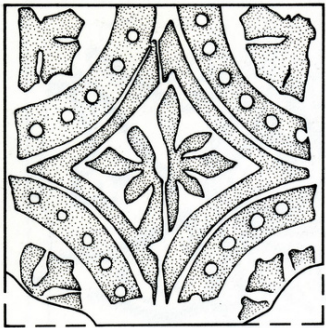


[132L] K. 5440°.



today is the last day of schools and it's been a while since i's been a student but if i were a student and had the next two months of complete and utter freedom i might just look up some history and submit to bitcoin history month on sn and even maybe just make one up and tell it so darn good that they have to like the stackers do and zap it but honest i's been a free bird ever since i killed that sonumbitch that laid his mousey little hands on my mother and is all to say i just feel everything opening up in the world and if you are a youngin then go out an grab em those days won't last forever seize those days grab a nice little hold of them all tender like like its the last thing you ever do because the wind it won't be at your backs forever



JUN 20 - JUN 26

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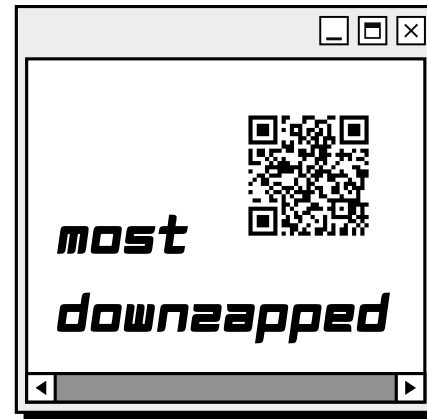
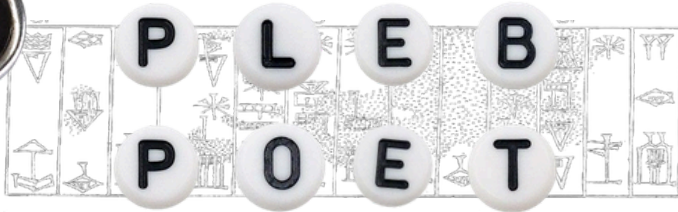
stacker news is the zappingest corner of
the internet

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stacker news zine is the printed
representation of the top posts found
there each week

Z

created by



WHY BIP-110
MATTERS
MORE THAN
EVER

5105 sats \ 42 comments
\ @daniella 22 Jun bitcoin
-13.9k sats

X

BITCOIN IS BECOMING FIAT

There are real financial incentives to flood Bitcoin with non-monetary data including .jpegs, inscriptions, ordinals, and tokens.[1][4][5][6][7]

- At scale, VC capital is paying for Bitcoin to not be Bitcoin. My independent research across 169 companies found that 56% of "Bitcoin-companies" have drifted into non-Bitcoin products, including every single company with a raise above \$50M.[2]
- STRC's Cantillon reconstruction on the protocol is another example of this. [3] It's the very "financial engineering" Bitcoin was designed to end.
- Many of the largest Bitcoin influencers, educators, and conference organisers are funded by the same fiat structures they claim to oppose. [8] Sponsorship, affiliate, and ad revenue create a feedback loop where the creator cannot scrutinise the company paying for their reach. At \$480,000 for a single sponsorship deal, the financial incentive to stay silent is structural, not personal.[8]

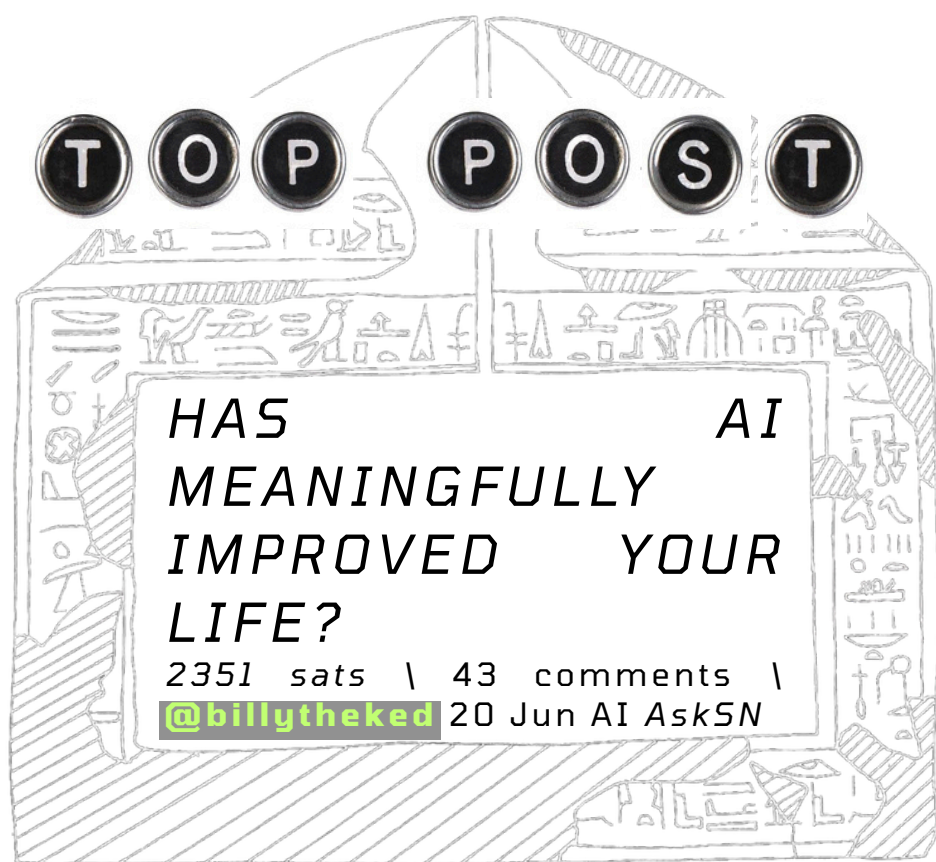
Across the entire industry, from development to marketing, the money is on the side of making Bitcoin not Bitcoin.

BITCOIN IS MONEY

Bitcoin was created to be money: "A peer-to-peer electronic cash system." That is the title of the white paper and the entire point of the protocol.[9] For 5,000 years, every civilisation that handed control of its money to a central authority followed the same sequence: Debasement, inflation, inequality, collapse, reset.[11] The flaw was centralized trust. Bitcoin is the first technology in history that removes it entirely, enforcing a fixed supply through mathematics and a decentralised network distributing trust. That is one of Bitcoin's most important contributions and it only works if the network stays decentralised.

....

<cont. online>



Explanations appreciated.

Personally, I'd have to say, No.

I know there will be a few people to disagree with this (some already have), and honestly, it's a complete shot in the dark so I'm willing to be wrong (I welcome being wrong). I just see/hear so many people on one side, and I think tempering our optimism might serve us well.

There's been a marginal improvement in how I can perform my job, but I still clock in and out at the same time. I'd be willing to bet, it more often it makes more work (longer emails from incompetent managers, false perceptions of competence, more review etc.)

Perhaps, if everyone makes even marginal improvements in their efficiency, then it might make a meaningful impact on human productivity. The challenge is, as it always is, in harnessing this toward significant and meaningful ends.

43 votes

YES	69.8%
NO	30.2%

264 sats \ 2 replies \ @Scoresby 20 Jun

I mostly use it when doing research and I'd say it is a lot faster than google search for finding things.

I often know where I want to look, but it's very good at finding things that I didn't know to look for.

85 sats \ 9 replies \ @npub1zapsats 20 Jun

AI has improved my working life as someone who didn't have a background in CS, but I want to mention something I always see when anyone brings it up

When devs say AI is slop, they're evaluating it against their years of learning code from scratch

When noobs say AI is amazing they're measuring it against pre AI, which was not being able to build anything at all

Those are two very different starting points

The critique that noobs can't review the code misses this distinction

The question isn't whether an amateur with AI is as capable as a senior dev

The question is whether a noob with AI is more capable than the same noob without AI

The answer is obviously yes



177 sats \ 3 replies \ @BlokchainB 20 Jun

Improved yes but meaningful I would say no.

Then again I am not an AI power user. I use it to fix my terrible writing skills but for the most part the improvements have been marginal.

Plus I haven't dove in 100% due to the privacy concerns. I am already cucked to the government, Apple, Google, do I need another platform knowing everything about me?

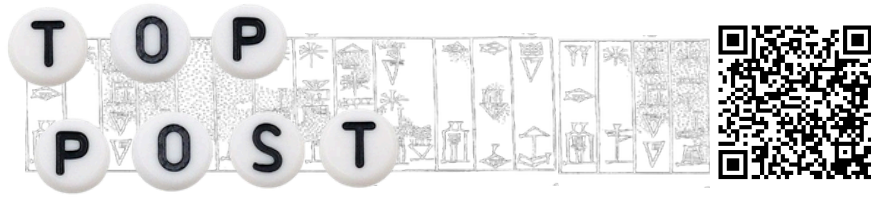
177 sats \ 2 replies \ @Undisciplined 20 Jun

My use cases are mostly just slight improvements in convenience or expedience.

I suspect I'll start using it for more substantial projects in the near future, though.

79 sats \ 0 replies \ @grayruby 20 Jun

Meaningfully no. But it has been useful.



"THIS SQUARE TERMINAL DOESN'T."

3438 sats \ 27 comments \ [@Scoresby](#) 24 Jun bitcoin

A dive bar date an anniversary doth not make

I decided to take the wife out for a night on the town for our anniversary this week. She often likes me to plan these sorts of things -- I believe she sees the effort I expend in the planning department as an expression of love and care. Seeing as this wasn't just any ordinary date, but an anniversary occasion, I decided to pull out the big guns.

We've been having fun with Texas two step dancing lately and through extensive research I discovered a place in Austin that was playing live music on a Tuesday night and thought I had a winner. Keep in mind the key feature of this bar was that it played dance music, I was not necessarily interested in other aspects of the establishment (my wife would later say that I did not pay attention to such aspects).

The odd thing about this bar was that it wasn't really in a commercial area. I had to do a doubletake when I was looking up directions because it's kinda in a weird residential neighborhood behind some strip malls and box stores. Nevertheless, we departed for our date.

Things seemed like they were looking up when we pulled into the pitted, dusty gravel parking lot: the yard had more plastic lawn chairs than grass and the building was kind of broken down (the front door looked like it wasn't in the frame right and there was a big handpainted piece of cardboard that said 'Danger! Use back door!') and the rusted metal roof was covered in spray paint - but the spray paint was actually quite nice, depicting antlers and the bar's name in fancy print. These are usually signs of a good honky tonk place.

Upon entering this fine establishment, we were confronted with a lonesome man playing an electric guitar in a manner that seemed tired although I suppose he meant it to be soulful. We later determined that he was part of a musical duo the other half of which was not in attendance due to some mishaps with a raccoon or armadillo or something.

We groped our way through the very dim interior to the bar to order drinks I discovered that they had a Square terminal.

A brief aside

I've been looking for Square terminals most of the places I go this year. Unfortunately, I rarely find them. Instead, I see all these other payment processors with names that can only be described as overly cozy. Normally, I'm not the kind of person who tries to orange pill or to preach the good orange word to others. But I've been getting hyped up by all you people with your stories of spending sats and such and I think I let the excitement of being able to pay for our date with sats get the better of me.

Diving in

We ordered margaritas from a woman who's exterior perfectly suited the building and went to sit down. We headed toward a very comfortable-looking corner table but ended up at a different table because upon closer inspection it seemed that someone had taken a knife (or perhaps a machete or chainsaw or something) to the upholstery of the black leather bench.

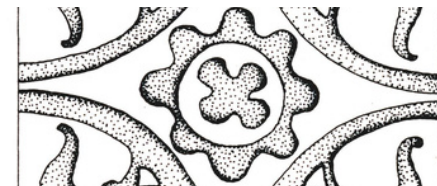
After we found a seat, a mournful dog came over and put her head in my wife's lap. I think she (my wife, not the dog) was startled by this and perhaps desired that I keep the animal from doing this. I did push it away some and she (the dog, not my wife) came and laid her head in my lap instead. The dog was incredibly reluctant to move elsewhere, despite my best efforts to shove its head off my lap.

It was at this point that we noticed the ceiling. It was one of those false ceilings like you might see in a cheap office or something, but it had the unique appearance of being a thousand years old. Pieces of some sort of dirty cloth were hanging from it in very dramatic tatters and in other places it had been completely gouged away to reveal the dark interior of the attic area.

When you looked across the bar at the stage, the ceiling gave the distinct impression of being on the verge of collapsing. The area above the musician was certainly several feet lower than where we were -- unless the man was a giant of some sort.

Then my wife began sneezing. In the course of the next ten minutes, she experienced an incredibly strong allergy attack. I kept her supplied with paper towels to blow her nose (the bar did not provide napkins) but it didn't seem to do much good.

I began to enjoy myself, sipping a margarita and listening to the blues which, if it wasn't Two Step music nor even terribly good, at least embodied the concept of the genre. Unfortunately, my wife's sneezing continued to get worse and we had to leave.



The big moment!

I approached the leathery bar woman with confidence. I had rehearsed this conversation many times in my head.

"Is that a Square terminal?" I asked, by way of introduction.

"A what?" she said.

"I see you use a Sqaure terminal. For payments." I clarified.

"Honey, we don't have none of that around here," she said.

"I'm ready to pay my tab," I said.

This inspired her to begin tapping on the Sqaure terminal I had referenced earlier.

"I heard that all those Square terminals accept bitcoin, now," I said, conversationally.

"Not this one," she said.

"No, they just announced that any Square terminal can accept bitcoin," I said. "I can show you if you like."

This seemed to raise some suspicion in her mind that I intended not to pay or perhaps to rob her fine establishment because the conversation became quite cold after this.

She told me how much I owed.

"I'm pretty sure all Square terminals can accept bitcoin," I said. For some reason at this point I showed her the lightning wallet app open on my phone.

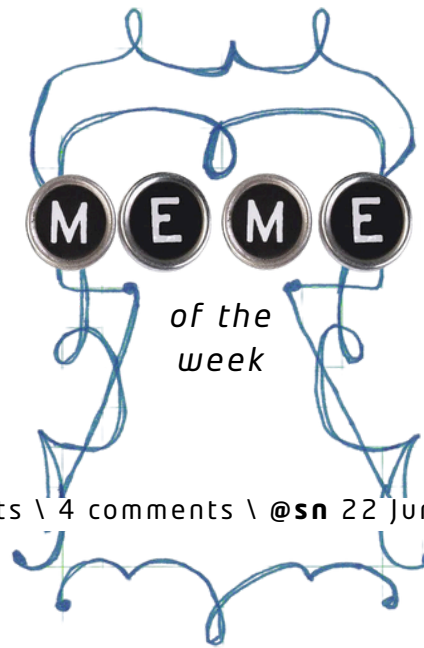
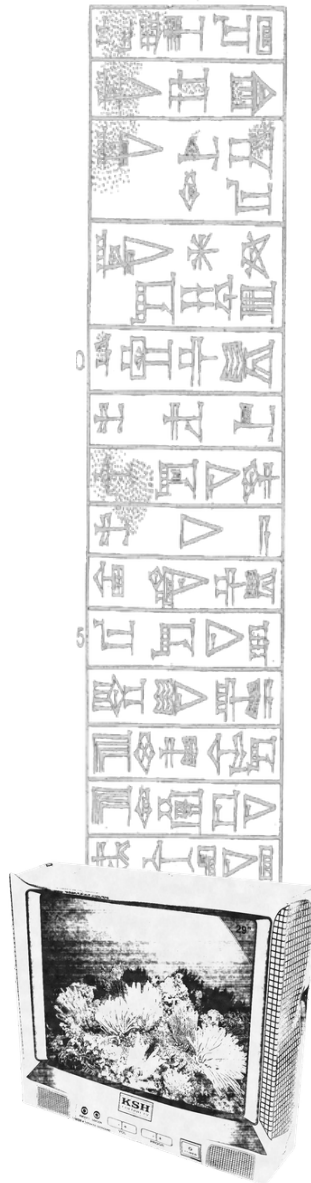
"This one does not take any of that," she said.

"Now how are you going to pay?"

During this educational conversation my wife continued to sneeze and the mournful dog continued to enjoy being very close to her -- the dog seemed quite old so perhaps it was just looking for something to learn on. But given the circumstances, I decided give up on my efforts to pay with sats and sadly had to resort to credit card.

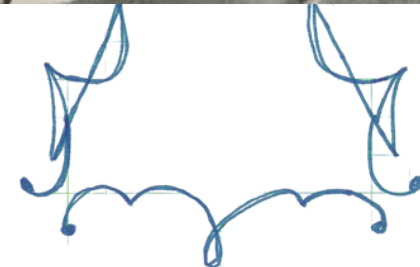
There's always next anniversary.

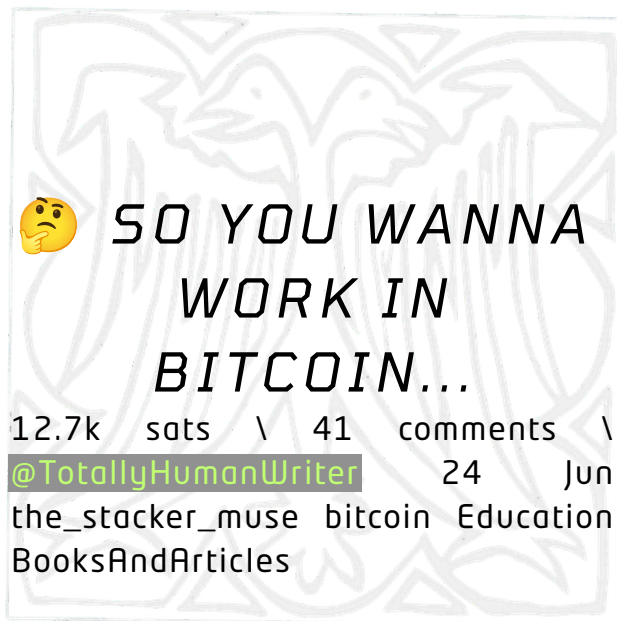
CONTINUED



242 sats \ 4 comments \ @sn 22 Jun memes

123 sats \ 0 replies \ @SHA256man 22 Jun





We're Fixing the Money, So Why Aren't We Getting Paid?

If you're reading this, you'd probably like a job in Bitcoin. Getting paid to help fix the world's money is a noble dream, right? It could pay your bills AND be your legacy.

But why dedicate your time to working in Bitcoin?

Seriously... why do you want a Bitcoin job?

- Is it because you believe you can explain Bitcoin so brilliantly, you, and only you, can orange pill the world?
- Is it because you identify as a radical cypherpunk and have built the one killer integration that will protect the network from ruin?
- Is it because you can't wait to tell your dickish boss you are quitting so you can work for the best money ever?

Just imagine it. You wake up, log in to X, and write your daily post. It goes viral and breaks the internet. The Bitcoin price rockets. Central banks crumble. We move to a Bitcoin standard, and humanity flourishes. All thanks to you.

But wait.

It's not that easy.

In fact, there are millions of hard-working eager bitcoiners just like you. They publish guides, articles, and courses. They offer consultancy services and try to solve real-world problems. They vibe-code apps and invest months and months into communities and passion projects.

What makes you think you'd do it any better? What makes you think you deserve to get paid?

If you work in the fiat world, you still have the thrill of converting as much of your economic energy to Bitcoin as you want. You get to see one world shrink as another grows.

Those fully in Bitcoin feel trapped. We live in a bubble: Satoshi's echo chamber filled with hopium and dank memes.

And why on Earth would you want to relinquish the cheap credit and inflated value of fiat? Bitcoin is terrifyingly honest. There is no faking it here. Crypto may be full of bad actors, but at least some of them are getting rich.

If you think you can clock in to your remote Bitcoin workstation to fix some bugs in the code or take a few video calls while cashing a \$15,000 monthly salary, forget it.

Here's a reality check from someone who has been working in the Bitcoin space since 2022: Working in Bitcoin sucks.

There are No Jobs in Bitcoin

Doing the Work

Bear Markets will Starve You

Where Has all the Money Gone?

Why the Fuck Do We Keep Going Then?

Imagine building a cathedral that you won't see finished. A monumental task of low time preference. It will be future generations who reap the rewards of your struggles and appreciate the strength of the foundations you laid and the beauty of your craftsmanship. That is a legacy.

Bitcoin can be both energizing and heartbreaking.

It can be beautiful and broken.

It brings joy and sorrow.

It is the cure and the pain.

That's the duality of fighting for freedom.

There is no one true path because bitcoiners don't measure success in fiat terms; we measure it in real long-term value.

If that aligns with your way of thinking, then I guess you might start working in Bitcoin too. Maybe I'll see you around, and we can compare notes and reminisce how easy our lives used to be.

And maybe, one day, we will laugh about tortured articles like these.

< this article continues on these points, and can be read in its entirety online >



THE SITUATION IN KRAMATORSK, UKRAINE (PART 2)

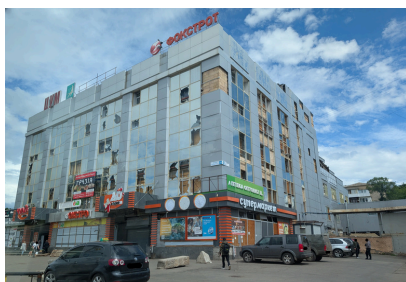
17.7k sats \ 20 comments \
@petertodd 25 Jun Travel bitcoin

Following up on my previous post where I delivered a Toyota Hilux to Kramatorsk, Ukraine, here's my report on the two nights I spent there (previously posted as an article on twitter):

After delivering the Toyota Hilux truck I stayed in Kramatorsk for another two nights to see how the situation has changed since my previous trip. And changed it has: as you will see, Russia is radically ramping up its efforts to destroy the Kramatorsk-Sloviansk area and force the civilian population out. It's a significantly more dangerous place to be than even a month ago.

But first things first: I still hadn't found them the Starlink they wanted. So we tracked down a store that had a single Starlink mini in stock at one of the main shopping areas:

21,900 UAH. A bit of a premium over the typical cost in Ukraine... But I mean, look at that building. About half of those missing windows are new, since the last time I had visited just a month prior, due yet another glide bomb (KAB) attack by Russia that landed on the road just ~15m away.



The unit needed the Starlink right away, so we got some fuel for my friend's perfectly normal, civilian car, at a perfectly normal, civilian, gas station:



Yes, it's open. Note the guy refilling his LPG car from the LPG tank hidden in the bunker; the one out in the open is definitely empty. Gas stations have been a priority target for Russia, as fuel distribution is critical to the civilian population; that gas station had been hit before.

I didn't get footage of us actually delivering the Starlink, as we took it to a sensitive location kinda close to the front lines. Close enough that my friend was teaching me the basics of defensive driving within fiber drone range: how to check corners for ambush drones while turning corners. Pretty simple concept: driver checks his side for drones; passenger simultaneously checks the other side. If you actually see a drone, one option is to jump out of the vehicle and hope that the goes for the high value vehicle rather than you. That's why they didn't care that the driver side seatbelt in the Toyota Hilux was broken...

With the Starlink delivered, I got to tag along with a medical officer in the unit while he checked in with some foreign volunteers from the USA who were taking time off in Kramatorsk to recover; we literally met them in a coffee shop. Concussions from near-miss encounters with drones are a serious issue. And as you can see by their patches, they took the issue very seriously:



But seriously, all joking aside, the Ukrainian military medical system is using the latest, most advanced, concussion protocols available to treat soldiers, informed by the US's experiences in Iraq and Afghanistan.

CONTINUED

...and after that, I went to get another coffee shop to hang out with my friend Sarah, and other less terminally online soldier friends of ours:

Something I want to stress here is how important it is to the soldiers that ordinary businesses like coffee shops and restaurants are still operating in Kramatorsk. When you're coming off long hours or even days in windowless bunkers, being able to go to somewhere normal and just... be normal is really important.

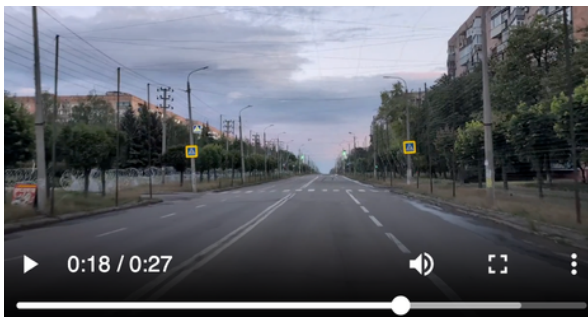
But that's changing. After coffee, Sarah and I went for a quick drive around Kramatorsk:

See the barbed wire and drone netting covering the road? That's all new.

While the barbed wire is just precautionary - that video was taken roughly 15km from Russian lines, and there's no way Russians are getting anywhere near it any time soon - the drone netting over the road has quickly become very relevant.

Both nights I stayed at an ordinary civilian apartment rented by some soldiers on the east side of Kramatorsk; I slept in my sleeping bag on a foam mat in the living room. That night you could periodically hear Russian fiber optic drones flying by us, often followed by gunshots as soldiers tried to shot them down. Or explosions if they hit something. And again, when we woke up in the morning Russia was still attacking our area with drones.

... They're a bit difficult to hear. But if you listen carefully you can hear the whine of the drones. I couldn't figure out where they actually were. I did see a drone in the distance at one point, a black spec identifiable as a drone rather than a bird by the fact that it was flying in a perfectly straight line. But it was too far to be one of the drones I was hearing; I decided not to stick my head out the window for a better look.



Once the active attack subsided, Sarah got a request to get some critical supplies for a group of soldiers located south of Kramatorsk, who were heading even further south to the front lines. In particular, baby wipes, anti-fungal cream, and waterless showers (basically a fancy wet wipe IIUC):

Laugh all you want. But hygiene is critical; every soldier I meet who has actually been in the field absolute loves wet wipes. Heck, with one of the trucks I've delivered, we included about \$300 worth of them.



... Finally, Sarah and I picked up a soldier who was leaving the unit; he had some final paperwork and other tasks to finish before getting on the bus to Kyiv. Most of the foreign volunteers I've met have come from western countries, especially the US and UK. This guy was unusual though, as he had been born in Africa, and later got residency in the EU. He'd struggled early on due to his poor English. But turned into a good soldier. Unfortunately he needed to leave Ukraine at his six months mark to keep his EU residency valid. But his plan was to re-enlist in a different unit he'd found with foreigners who spoke his native language. ...



I also want to talk about how this changes the psychology of the situation for the civilians in the area. In my previous trip, before Russia started pouring resources into attacking Kramatorsk with fiber drones, while Kramatorsk was still a relatively dangerous place, your main threat was glide bombs and cluster bombs

Those weapons are relatively random, and aside from just hiding in bunkers all day (air raids can easily last 12 hours in Kramatorsk), there's not that much you can do. If your time is up, it's up. Which makes the danger easier to just ignore and get on with your life.

FPV drones on the other hand are active weapons: there is a Russian soldier on the other end potentially looking right at you via the camera. That Russian may very well decide to kill you. Yet, with the right response, you can stay alive and turn an attack into a near miss, or at least a non-fatal injury. But that means constantly thinking about the threat. Something no civilian should have to do. In any case, with my fiber collected (and one quick trip to Nova Poshta to get an envelope to put it in), I got on my bus and left Kramatorsk. For now.

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